DEFINING GRAMMAR AND GRAMMATICAL UNITS

Grammar?

Different scholars have defined grammar in different ways, each emphasizing different aspects of this complex system. The word grammar comes from the ancient Greek word "grammatike" which means "the art of writing and reading." Over time, the meaning has expanded to include all the rules and patterns of a language.

Definitions of Grammar

Let us examine definitions from six important scholars and organizations. Each definition shows us a different way to understand grammar.

Encyclopaedia Britannica

According to Encyclopaedia Britannica, grammar is "the rules of a language governing the sounds, words, sentences, and other elements, as well as their combination and interpretation."

This definition tells us that grammar includes:

- ★ Rules for sounds (phonology) Rules for words (morphology) Rules for sentences (syntax) Rules for meaning (semantics)

- ★ Example is The rule that we add "ed" to make past tense (walk becomes walked) is a grammar rule.

Noam Chomsky

Noam Chomsky is the most famous linguist in the world today. He defined grammar as "a system of rules that in some explicit and well defined way assigns structural descriptions to sentences."

Chomsky's view is that grammar is:

- ★ A system (not just random rules)
- ★ Explicit (clear and specific)
- ★ Generative (can create infinite sentences)
- ★ Structural (shows how sentences are built)

Chomsky also proposed that humans have an innate capacity for language called Universal Grammar. This means that all human languages share some fundamental properties because of how our brains are structured.

- ★ Example is the rule that in English we say "the big house" (adjective before noun) and not "the house big" is part of our mental grammar system.

Michael Halliday

Michael Halliday was a British linguist who founded Systemic Functional Linguistics. According to Halliday, "Grammar is described as systems not as rules, on the basis that every grammatical structure involves a choice from a describable set of options."

Halliday's view is that grammar is:

- ★ A system of choices (not rigid rules)
- ★ Functional (serves purposes in communication)
- ★ Meaning making (helps us express ideas)

For Halliday, grammar is about making choices to create meaning in social contexts.

- ★ For example, when we want to ask a question, we choose between "Did you eat?" (yes/no question) and "What did you eat?" (information question). Grammar gives us these options.

David Crystal

David Crystal is a British linguist and author of many grammar books. He defines grammar as "the study of all the contrasts of meaning that it is possible to make within sentences."

Crystal's view emphasizes that grammar is about:

- ★ Meaning (not just form)
- ★ Contrasts (how changing structure changes meaning)
- ★ Systematic patterns

- ★ An example is "The dog bit the man" versus "The man bit the dog." The word order change completely changes the meaning. This is what grammar controls.

Randolph Quirk and colleagues

Randolph Quirk, Sidney Greenbaum, Geoffrey Leech, and Jan Svartvik wrote "A Comprehensive Grammar of the English Language" in 1985. They define grammar as "the

central processing unit of language, the component where linguistic forms are organised according to meaning."

This definition tells us that grammar:

- ★ Organizes language forms Connects form and meaning Is central to language (like a computer's processing unit)
- ★ For example, the grammar rule for making plurals (add 's' to most nouns) connects the form (cats) to the meaning (more than one cat).

Leonard Bloomfield

Leonard Bloomfield was an American linguist. He defined grammar as "the meaningful arrangement of forms" in a language.

Bloomfield's view focused on:

- ★ Arrangement (how elements are ordered)
- ★ Forms (the actual units like words and affixes)
- ★ Meaningfulness (arrangement affects meaning)

- ★ For example, the arrangement of words determines meaning.
  "Dog bites man" is different from "Man bites dog" even though the words are the same.

Common elements in all definitions

Although these scholars define grammar differently, all definitions share some common ideas.

1. Grammar is systematic. It follows patterns and rules, not chaos.
2. Grammar involves structure. It shows how elements combine.
3. Grammar relates to meaning. Structure affects what we communicate.
4. Grammar is about choices. We select from options to express ideas.
5. Grammar is rule governed. Even when flexible, grammar has principles.

Two Main Perspectives On Grammar

From these definitions, we can identify two main ways of viewing grammar:

Perspective 1 (Prescriptive Grammar)

Prescriptive grammar tells people how they should speak or write. It establishes standards for "correct" usage.

- ★ "Don't split infinitives" (prescriptive rule).

This means don't say "to boldly go" but rather "to go boldly."

- ★ "Never end a sentence with a preposition (prescriptive rule).
  This means don't say "Who did you talk to?" but rather "To whom did you talk?"

Prescriptive grammar is important for formal writing and education, but many prescriptive rules are not based on how people actually use language.

Perspective 2 (Descriptive Grammar)

Descriptive grammar describes how people actually speak and write. It observes and analyzes real language use.

- ★ Descriptive grammar observes that English speakers often split infinitives ("to boldly go") and this is perfectly natural in English.

- ★ Descriptive grammar notes that ending sentences with prepositions ("Who did you talk to?") is common and natural in English.

Most modern linguists use descriptive grammar because it shows the real patterns in language.

GRAMMATICAL UNITS

Language is organized in a hierarchy. Smaller units combine to form larger units. Understanding this hierarchy is essential for studying grammar.

The Hierarchy of Grammatical Units

The grammatical units in English are arranged from smallest to largest.

Morpheme - smallest unit of *meaning* (can't be broken down further and a morpheme is **a unit of meaning**; it *can* be a word, but it doesn't have to be.(un, s, ,ed)

Word - smallest, meaningful unit that can *stand alone* in a sentence (dog, cat, happy)

Phrase - A phrase is a **group of words** that works together

Clause - A clause is a group of words that **has both a subject + a verb**

Sentence - A sentence is a **complete thought**

Text/Discourse - This is the **largest unit**- a **collection of sentences** connected together.

1. MORPHEME

A morpheme is the **smallest unit of meaning** in a language that **cannot be broken down** into smaller meaningful parts. There are two main types of morphemes. They are

- ★ free morphemes - A morpheme that **can stand alone** as a word. (cat, book, run, happy)
- ★ bound morphemes - A morpheme that **cannot stand alone** — it must be attached to another word. (un, dis, able, ible)

2. WORD

A word is the smallest independent unit that can stand alone and carry meaning. It is a unit of language that can be spoken or written independently.

- ★ cat, run, beautiful, the, and, quickly

Types of Words (Parts of Speech)

In English grammar, words are classified into different categories called parts of speech or word classes.

There are eight main parts of speech.

- ★ Noun - A word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.
- ★ Verb - A word that shows action or state of being.
- ★ Adjective- A word that describes a noun.
- ★ Adverb- A word that describes a verb, adjective, or another adverb.
- ★ Pronoun- A word that replaces a noun
- ★ Preposition- A word that shows the relationship between a noun and another word.
- ★ Conjunction- A word that connects words, phrases, or clauses.
- ★ Interjection- A word that expresses strong emotion.

Understanding Words and Morphemes

A word is the smallest independent unit, and words themselves can be broken down into even smaller meaningful units called morphemes.

A morpheme is the smallest unit of meaning in a language.

- ★ The word "cat" contains one morpheme (cat).
  The word "cats" contains two morphemes (cat + s). The "s" is a morpheme meaning "plural."

★ The word "unhappiness" contains three morphemes (un + happy + ness).
-un means "not" , happy means "happy" , ness means "state of being"

3. PHRASE

A phrase is a group of words that function together as a single unit, but does not contain both a subject and a predicate (verb + everything after it). A phrase has either a noun or a verb structure, but not both together.

★ A phrase cannot stand alone as a complete sentence.

Types of Phrases

There are five main types of phrases in English.

Type 1 (Noun Phrase / NP)

A noun phrase is a **group of words** that has a **noun as its main word (head)** + other words that describe or modify it.

Just a Noun	**Noun Phrase**
dog	**the big black dog**
girl	**the beautiful young girl**
car	**a fast red car**

- Noun Phrase = Modifier(s) + Noun (head)

- The **noun** is the most important word. Everything else **describes** the noun.

What Can Come Before a Noun?

Element	Example	Role
Article	*the, a, an*	identifies the noun
Adjective	*big, happy, old*	describes the noun
Number	*three, first*	counts the noun
Possessive	*my, his, their*	shows ownership

Type 2 (Verb Phrase / VP)

A verb phrase is a group of words built around a verb as the main word.
A verb phrase is a **group of words** that has a **verb as its main word (head)** + other words that complete its meaning.

Structure - (Auxiliary Verb) + MAIN VERB + (Other Elements)

"is running" (auxiliary + main verb)
"has been working" (auxiliary + auxiliary + main verb)
"will have completed" (auxiliary + auxiliary + main verb)

Type 3 (Adjective Phrase / AdjP)

An adjective phrase is a group of words built around an adjective. In other words, an **Adjective Phrase** is a phrase where the **adjective is the HEAD** + words that modify or intensify it.

Just Adjective	Adjective Phrase
Happy	**very happy**
Tall	**extremely tall**
Tired	**very tired indeed**
Good	**good enough**

What Comes Before Adjectives?

These are called Pre-modifiers.

Pre-modifier	**Adjective**	**Adjective Phrase**
very	happy	very happy
extremely	tall	extremely tall
quite	good	quite good
really	tired	really tired
so	beautiful	so beautiful
too	hot	too hot
fairly	easy	fairly easy

What Comes After the Adjectives?

These are called Post-modifiers.

Adjective	Post-modifier	Adjective Phrase
good	enough	good enough
happy	indeed	happy indeed
proud	of her son	proud of her son
afraid	of the dark	afraid of the dark
happy	to see you	happy to see you
sure	about that	sure about that

Two Positions of Adjective Phrase

Position 1: ATTRIBUTIVE (Before the Noun)

Adjective Phrase	Noun	Full Sentence
very tall	man	The very tall man walked in.
extremely hot	food	The extremely hot food burned my mouth.
really beautiful	flower	She picked a really beautiful flower.

Position 2: PREDICATIVE (After Linking Verb)

Subject	Linking Verb	Adjective Phrase
She	is	very happy
He	seems	quite tired
The food	looks	really good
She	feels	so proud of her son
He	became	very famous

Type 4 (Adverb Phrase / AdvP)

An adverb phrase is a group of words built around an adverb.
An **Adverb Phrase** is a phrase where the **adverb is the HEAD** + words that modify or intensify it.

Just Adverb	**Adverb Phrase**
quickly	very quickly
slowly	extremely slowly
soon	quite soon
well	really well

Type 5 (Prepositional Phrase / PP)

A prepositional phrase is a group of words that begins with a preposition and ends with a noun or pronoun (called the object of the preposition).

Structure - PREPOSITION + Noun Phrase

Preposition	**Noun Phrase**	**Prepositional Phrase**
in	*the room*	in the room
on	*the table*	on the table
at	*school*	at school
under	*the bed*	under the bed
after	*the class*	after the class
with	*her friend*	with her friend

3 (CLAUSE)

A clause is a group of words that contains both a subject and a predicate (verb).

The Key Difference between a phrase and a clause is:
A phrase does not have both subject and verb. A clause DOES have both subject and verb.

➔ Parts of a Clause

Every clause has two essential parts.
Part 1 (Subject) - The person or thing that the clause is about. The subject performs the action or is described.

Part 2 (Predicate) - The part that says something about the subject. The predicate must contain a verb (Verb + everything after it).

★ The students completed their homework.
"The students" is the subject.
"completed their homework" is the predicate.

➔ Types of Clauses

There are two main types of clauses.

Type 1 (Independent Clause / Main Clause)

An independent clause is a clause that can stand alone as a complete sentence. It expresses a complete thought.

★ I love reading. (This is a complete thought.)
★ She went to the market. (This is a complete thought.)
★ The children are playing. (This is a complete thought.)

Every simple sentence is an independent clause.

Type 2 (Dependent Clause / Subordinate Clause)

A dependent clause is a clause that cannot stand alone as a complete sentence. It depends on an independent clause to complete its meaning.

Dependent clauses begin with subordinating words like:
Subordinating Conjunctions - because, although, if, when, while, since, unless, after, before
Relative Pronouns - who, which, that, whose, whom

★ because I love reading (This is not a complete thought.)

- ★ when she went to the market (This is not a complete thought.)
- ★ which are playing in the garden (This is not a complete thought.)

Each dependent clause needs an independent clause to sound meaningful.

- ★ I bought many books because I love reading. (complete sentence)
- ★ When she went to the market, she met her friend. (complete sentence)
- ★ The children which are playing in the garden are very happy. (complete sentence)

4 (SENTENCE)

A sentence is a grammatical unit that expresses a complete thought. Every sentence must have at least one independent clause.

Requirements for a Grammatical Sentence

For a sentence to be grammatically correct and complete, it must have:

- ★ At least one independent clause (with subject and predicate)
- ★ A complete thought
- ★ Proper punctuation (capital letter at the beginning, period/question mark/exclamation mark at the end)

➔ Types of Sentences by Structure

Sentences can be classified into four types based on their clause structure;

Type 1 (Simple Sentence)

A simple sentence contains ONE independent clause and NO dependent clauses.

- ★ The dog barks. (one independent clause)
- ★ Mary and John went to the market. (one independent clause with compound subject)
- ★ She bought apples, oranges, and bananas. (one independent clause with compound object)

A simple sentence can still be long if it has many phrases, but it has only one subject-verb combination.

Type 2 (Compound Sentence)

A compound sentence contains two or more independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction (and, but, or, so, yet, for, nor).

- ★ I love tea, but she loves coffee. (two independent clauses)
- ★ He studied hard, and he passed the exam. (two independent clauses)
- ★ We can go to the movies, or we can stay home. (two independent clauses)

Type 3 (Complex Sentence)

A complex sentence contains ONE independent clause and ONE or MORE dependent clauses.

- ★ When the rain stopped, we went outside. (dependent clause + independent clause)
- ★ I will help you if you ask me. (independent clause + dependent clause)
- ★ The book that you gave me is very interesting. (independent clause with embedded dependent clause)

Type 4 (Compound Complex Sentence)

A compound complex sentence contains two or more independent clauses and one or more dependent clauses.

- ★ When I arrived, she was cooking, and he was reading. (dependent clause + two independent clauses)
- ★ I finished my work, and I went home because I was tired. (two independent clauses + dependent clause)

CLAUSE ELEMENTS

Every clause is made up of different elements or functions. These elements work together to create meaning.

Understanding clause elements helps us analyze sentence structure and understand how meaning is created.

The Five Main Clause Elements

There are five main elements that can appear in a clause.

1. Subject (S)
2. Verb / Predicator (V)
3. Object (O)
4. Complement (C)
5. Adverbial / Adjunct (A)

Element 1 - (SUBJECT / S)

The subject is the person, thing, or idea that the clause is about. The subject typically performs the action (in active sentences) or is described.

To find the subject, ask "Who or what is performing the action?" or "Who or what is the clause about?"

- ★ "The students are studying." (Who is studying? The students.)
- ★ "My best friend loves pizza." (Who loves pizza? My best friend.)
- ★ "Reading books is enjoyable." (What is enjoyable? Reading books.)

➔ **Types of Subjects**

Type 1 (Simple Subject) - The main noun or pronoun alone.

- ★ "Dogs bark."

Type 2 (Complete Subject) - The simple subject plus all its modifiers.

- ★ "The big brown dog from next door barks loudly."

Type 3 (Compound Subject)- Two or more subjects joined by a conjunction.

- ★ "Mary and John are friends."

➔ **What Can Function as a Subject?**

Noun - The cat sleeps.
Pronoun - She is beautiful.
Noun Phrase - The beautiful flowers in the garden smell nice.
Gerund (ing form) - Swimming is healthy.
Noun Clause - What you said is true.

Element 2 (VERB / PREDICATOR / V)

The verb (also called predicator by some grammarians) is the element that expresses the action or state in the clause. The Predicator is the HEART of the sentence. No sentence exists without it.
The word "verb" can mean two things:

1. Verb as a word class (a type of word like noun, adjective, etc.)
2. Verb as a clause element (the function it performs in a clause/ The **functional role** the verb plays in a sentence)

➔ **Types of Verbs by Function**

Type 1 (Action Verbs) - express physical or mental actions.
run, jump, eat, think, believe

Type 2 (Linking Verbs / Copular Verbs) - link the subject to a description or identification. They do not show action.

- ★ The main linking verb is be (am, is, are, was, were, been)
- ★ Other linking verbs are seem, appear, become, feel, look, sound, taste, smell, remain

She is a teacher. (linking verb)
The soup tastes delicious. (linking verb)
He became angry. (linking verb)

➔ **Types of Verbs by Object Requirement**

Type 1 (Transitive Verbs) - require an object to complete their meaning.
She ate an apple. (ate requires an object)
I love music. (love requires an object)

Type 2 (Intransitive Verbs) - do NOT require an object.
The baby cried. (cried does not need an object)
Birds fly. (fly does not need an object)

Type 3 (Ditransitive Verbs) - require TWO objects.
She gave me a book. (gave requires two objects)
He told us a story. (told requires two objects)

Element 3 (OBJECT / O)

An object is the person or thing that is affected by the action of the verb. Objects only appear with transitive verbs.

➔ **Types of Objects**

Type 1 (Direct Object) - receives the action of the verb directly. To find the direct object, ask "What?" or "Whom?" after the verb.

- ★ I read a book. (Read what? A book.)
- ★ She loves her mother. (Love whom? Her mother.)
- ★ They built a house. (Built what? A house.)

Type 2 (Indirect Object / Oi) - indicates to whom or for whom the action is done. The indirect object appears before the direct object. To find the indirect object, ask "To whom?" or "For whom?"

- ★ She gave me a gift. (Gave a gift to whom? To me.)
- ★ He told us a story. (Told a story to whom? To us.)
- ★ I bought my sister a dress. (Bought a dress for whom? For my sister.)

Alternative Structure - Instead of using two objects, we can use a prepositional phrase
She gave a gift to me. (now only one object + prepositional phrase)
He told a story to us.
I bought a dress for my sister.

- ★ Normal ditransitive: She gave me a gift.
  ↑ Indirect Object (no preposition, TWO objects)

- ★ Alternative structure: She gave a gift to me.
  ↑ Prepositional Phrase (to/for + indirect object)
  (ONE object + prepositional phrase)

➔ What Can Function as an Object?

Noun - I like coffee.
Pronoun - She loves him.
Noun Phrase - I bought a beautiful red dress.
Gerund - I enjoy swimming.
Infinitive - I want to eat.
Noun Clause - I know that you are right.

Element 4 (COMPLEMENT / C)

A complement is an element that completes the meaning of the subject or object by providing additional information about it.

Complements differ from objects because complements DESCRIBE or RENAME, while objects RECEIVE action.

➔ Types of Complements

Type 1 (Subject Complement / Cs) - provides information about the subject.
Subject complements appear after linking verbs (be, seem, become, etc.).

- ★ She is a teacher, (subject = complement)
- ★ The soup tastes delicious.(subject = complement)
- ★ He became angry. (subject = complement)

In each example, the complement describes or identifies the subject.

Type 2 (Object Complement / Co) - provides information about the object.
Object complements appear after certain verbs like make, call, elect, consider, find.

- ★ They elected him president. (him = president)
- ★ We call her Mary. (her = Mary)
- ★ The result made us happy. (us = happy)

In each example, the complement describes or renames the object.

Element 5 (ADVERBIAL / ADJUNCT / A)

An adverbial (also called adjunct) is an element that provides additional information about the action, time, place, manner, reason, purpose, etc. Unlike subjects, verbs, objects, and complements, adverbials are usually optional. They add information but are not always required for the sentence to be grammatical.

➔ Types of Adverbials by Meaning

Type 1 (Adverbial of Manner) - tells us how something happens.
She speaks fluently.
He walked slowly.
They completed the work with great care.

Type 2 (Adverbial of Time) - tells us when something happens.
I will call you tomorrow.
She arrived at 3 o'clock.
Last week, we went to London.

Type 3 (Adverbial of Place) - tells us where something happens.
They live in Paris.
Put the book on the table.
In the garden, there are many flowers.

Type 4 (Adverbial of Frequency) - tells us how often something happens.
I always brush my teeth.
She visits her parents every week.
Rarely does he make mistakes.

Type 5 (Adverbial of Degree) - tells us to what extent.
I completely agree.
She is very beautiful.
He almost finished.

Type 6 (Adverbial of Reason) - tells us why something happens.
She left because she was tired.
He studied hard to pass the exam.

Type 7 (Adverbial of Purpose) - tells us for what purpose.
She went to the store to buy milk.
I am saving money in order to travel.

➔ **Obligatory vs. Optional Adverbials**

Most adverbials are optional and can be removed without making the sentence ungrammatical.

★ She runs quickly. ➡️ She runs. (still grammatical)

However, some verbs require an adverbial to be grammatical. These are called obligatory adverbials.

★ She put the book on the table. (on the table is obligatory) You cannot say "She put the book." It is incomplete.
★ They live in Paris. ("in Paris" is obligatory) You cannot say "They live." It is incomplete.

WORD ORDER AND SENTENCE PATTERNS IN ENGLISH

Word order is the arrangement of words in a sentence. Different languages have different word order patterns. In English, word order is relatively fixed and very important because we do not have many word endings. Word order shows us which word is the subject, which is the object, etc.

Basic Word Order in English

The basic word order in English is Subject + Verb + Object.

The teacher explained the lesson.

Subject - "The teacher"
Verb - "explained"
Object - "the lesson"
If we change the order, the meaning changes or the sentence becomes ungrammatical.

"The lesson explained the teacher." (different meaning!)
"Explained the teacher the lesson." (ungrammatical!)

The Seven Basic Sentence Patterns in English

English sentences can be organized into seven basic patterns depending on which clause elements appear and in what order. These patterns are recognized by major grammar books including "A Comprehensive Grammar of the English Language" by Quirk and colleagues (1985).

The seven patterns use these abbreviations

S = Subject
V = Verb
O = Object
C = Complement
A = Adverbial

Pattern 1 (SV: Subject + Verb)

This is the simplest pattern. It contains only a subject and an intransitive verb (a verb that does not need an object).

Subject	Verb
Birds	fly.
The baby	cried.
Something	happened.
Time	passes.
We	laughed.

These sentences are complete even though they have only two elements. The verbs (fly, cried, happened, passes, laughed) are intransitive and do not need objects.

- ★ Students work.
- ★ The sun rises.
- ★ Flowers bloom.

Pattern 2 (SVO: Subject + Verb + Object)

This is the most common pattern in English. It contains a subject, a transitive verb, and a direct object.

Subject	Verb	Object
I	love	music.
She	reads	books.
The dog	chased	the cat.
Students	study	grammar.

In this pattern, the action of the verb affects the object. The object receives the action. The object is necessary for the sentence to be complete. You cannot say "I love" or "She reads" without an object.

Pattern 3 (SVC: Subject + Verb + Complement)

This pattern contains a subject, a linking verb, and a subject complement.

Subject	Verb	Complement
She	is	a teacher.
The food	tastes	delicious.
He	became	angry.
They	are	students.
The story	sounds	interesting.

The complement describes or identifies the subject. In each example, Subject = Complement. Common linking verbs in this pattern are be, seem, appear, become, remain, feel, look, sound, taste, smell.

- ★ "She is a teacher" means She = a teacher. The complement renames or describes the subject.
- ★ My brother is a doctor.
- ★ The weather seems nice.

Pattern 4 (SVA: Subject + Verb + Adverbial)

This pattern contains a subject, a verb, and an obligatory adverbial. The adverbial is required for the sentence to be complete.

Subject	Verb	Adverbial
She	lives	in Paris.
The meeting	is	on Monday.
The book	is	on the table.
They	went	to school.
He	works	in a hospital.

In this pattern, the adverbial (usually of place or time) is necessary. You cannot remove it.
"She lives" is incomplete. You must say "She lives in Paris" or "She lives here" to make it complete.

- ★ The keys are in the drawer.
- ★ They stayed at home.
- ★ The cat sat on the mat.

Pattern 5 (SVOO: Subject + Verb + Object + Object)

This pattern contains a subject, a verb, an indirect object, and a direct object.

Structure - Subject + Verb + Indirect Object + Direct Object

Subject	Verb	Indirect Object	Direct Object
She	gave	me	a gift.
He	told	us	a story.
I	sent	her	a letter.
They	taught	the students	English.
My mother	made	me	a cake.

The indirect object is the recipient (person who receives). The direct object is the thing given or communicated.

- ★ I bought my sister a present.
- ★ The teacher asked the students a question.
- ★ He showed me his new car.

Pattern 6 (SVOC: Subject + Verb + Object + Complement)

This pattern contains a subject, a verb, an object, and an object complement. The complement describes or renames the object.

Structure - Subject + Verb + Object + Object Complement

Subject	Verb	Object	Complement
They	elected	him	president.
We	call	her	Mary.
The news	made	us	happy.
I	consider	him	a friend.
She	painted	the wall	blue.

The complement gives information about the object. In each example, Object = Complement. In "They elected him president," him = president. The complement renames the object.

- ★ The judge declared him innocent.
- ★ We found the movie boring.
- ★ They appointed her director.

Pattern 7 (SVOA: Subject + Verb + Object + Adverbial)

This pattern contains a subject, a verb, an object, and an obligatory adverbial.

Structure - Subject + Verb + Object + Adverbial

Subject	Verb	Object	Adverbial
I	put	the book	on the table.
She	placed	the vase	on the shelf.

Subject	Verb	Object	Adverbial
He	put	his keys	in his pocket.
They	kept	the money	in the safe.

The adverbial (usually of place) is necessary to complete the meaning. You cannot remove it.
"I put the book" is incomplete. You must say WHERE you put it.

- ★ We laid the carpet on the floor.
- ★ She set the cup on the desk.

Difference from SVO:
SVO → adverbial OPTIONAL (can remove)
SVOA → adverbial ESSENTIAL (cannot remove)

Pattern	Formula	Example	Required Elements
1	SV	Birds fly.	Subject + Intransitive Verb
2	SVO	I love music.	Subject + Transitive Verb + Object
3	SVC	She is a teacher.	Subject + Linking Verb + Complement
4	SVA	She lives in Paris.	Subject + Verb + Obligatory Adverbial
5	SVOO	She gave me a gift.	Subject + Verb + Indirect Object + Direct Object
6	SVOC	They elected him president.	Subject + Verb + Object + Complement
7	SVOA	I put the book on the table.	Subject + Verb + Object + Obligatory Adverbial

Word Order in Questions

In statements, the word order is Subject + Verb + Other Elements.
In questions, the word order changes.

➔ Yes/No Questions

To form yes/no questions, we use **auxiliary verb + subject + main verb.**

- ★ Statement - She is working.

Question - Is she working?"

★ Statement - They have finished.
Question - Have they finished?

★ Statement - He can swim.
Question - Can he swim?

If there is no auxiliary verb, we use do/does/did.

★ Statement - She works hard.
Question - Does she work hard?

★ Statement - They went home.
Question - Did they go home?

➔ Wh-Questions

Wh-questions begin with question words (who, what, where, when, why, how).

Structure - Wh-word + Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb + Other Elements

★ What do you want?
★ Where does she live?
★ When did they arrive?
★ Why are you crying?
★ How can I help you?

Word Order in Negative Sentences

To make negative sentences, we add “not” after the auxiliary verb.

★ Positive - She is working.
Negative - She is not (isn't) working.

★ Positive - They have arrived.
Negative - They have not (haven't) arrived.

If there is no auxiliary verb, we use do/does/did + not.
Positive - She works hard.
Negative - She does not (doesn't) work hard.

Positive - They went home.
Negative - They did not (didn't) go home.